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Computer Science Module Choice Opinions 2022-23

What is this???

This document is a place for people to comment on modules running next year, so younger students can get advice from older students about what modules will suit you best. Think of it as a mini-wikipedia for modules next year, but opinions as well as facts. Feel free to put whatever you want below, and also edit other pieces of advice to neaten things up. If you don't agree - don't just delete. Comment underneath saying you disagree or explain why.

Disclaimery thing: this is just crowdsourced so we might all be lying, look at the department's actual comms and website about stuff for more information.

Template

Module Code	Module Name	Semester 1 Credits	Semester 2 Credits
• Add your opinion here…			

Links!

- 2021-22 document
- full list of modules on SoCS website
- CSS Discord (join the server and ask people questions about modules)

Compulsory Modules

Computer Science Project

06-26581	**BSc Computer Science Project**	**20**	**20**

- Oh lord it's the big boi
- Your FYP (final year project) is the single most important thing you'll do in your degree
    - It will be hard
    - You don't need to let it kill you tho, just treat it like a big project and chip away at it gradually.
        - If it is killing you, do something about it
        - Speak to your supervisor
        - Speak to welfare
        - It's not meant to be impossible, just challenging.
- After Module Choices, you will be asked to pick a supervisor
    - Make sure you pick your supervisor wisely.
    - Some supervisors are better than others.
    - Don't just go for someone with experience.
    - Ask the academics how they like to supervise, pick someone who fits in well with your supervisor.
    - Some supervisors will expect you to choose a subject related to their research areas, some will be chill with you doing something completely different. Ask first!
    - **Picking the right supervisor > Picking the right project**
    - ^^ imo if you get unlucky with your supervisor matching but have a good project idea, it can be enough to carry you through
    - You should get a list of staff members and their research interests when they ask you to decide on a supervisor
    - You'll probably be asked to make a list of 5 preferred supervisors. They'll use a matching algorithm to match students to their preferred supervisors, in a way that stops supervisors being oversubscribed. You aren't guaranteed to get a supervisor you want, but it's not that common for this to happen
    - If you don't get any of the supervisors you want, it's not the end of the world. If you end up with someone who doesn't match your interests because everyone else was already taken, they will likely be fine with learning about your project topic with you
    - You will probably get allocated supervisors around the end of May / start of June
- The general trend is that your first term is a lot of dawdling and then the pressure sets in in the second term. Do try to avoid this! If you can make a decent amount of effort in your first time you will be saving yourself some amount of stress
- Don't worry about thinking of an idea for your project during the summer - most people

ideas. Even if you don't work out what you want to do over the summer, at least think about what you find interesting in the modules you've already done. Think of one, or more, research areas which you would like to explore. Then in September, you will find a concrete idea for a project in the first 2 weeks or so.

- You will also have a project inspector. You will have to present to this person twice in the year where you will talk about what you are doing and they will give advice in regards to improving it. They will also be the other person marking your project. This person is (seemingly) randomly allocated, so they may not be experts in your chosen project domain.
- Make sure to commit your code to Git after you make a change. They have very little sympathy if you lose your code because your laptop died.
- Try to show enthusiasm about your project to your supervisor and make regular contact with them - a good impression can only help you when it comes to marking your project. The same goes for the project inspector in the couple of inspections you'll have with them

06-26587	**MSci Computer Science Project**	**20**	**40**

- Like the BSc project, just harder.
  - You'll need to do more work and have one extra assessment (probably a video in second semester)
  - There's more of a focus on it being research driven / more academic
  - You get more time to do it, as you have more free time in the second semester. It also means that you will have one less module to do (3 instead of 4)
- For reference the total word count in your final report is 50% more than BSc, so use this as a guide (with a pinch of salt) on how much you'll have to work. Also it is 60 instead of 40 credits.

Optional Modules

06-35309	**Advanced Functional Programming**	-	20
06-35325	**Advanced Functional Programming (Extended)**	-	20

- If you **loved** Agda then this is the one for you. It's certainly a challenge and there's quite a bit of work to do, but you go into great detail into the language. There are two 50% class tests that decide your fate. The most difficult module I had to take but I chose the less tricky ones for me (mobile, networks, hci)
    - The lecturers & TAs are very good in terms of help & the teaching overall. Very often replying quickly and helpfully.
- It's very different from the base Functional programming module. It's much more logical, especially the first few weeks. It's probably the most intense module I've got this semester. Martin is fantastic still, if you enjoyed base Functional and the first year logic module, then I think it's definitely worth giving a go.
- I didn't enjoy first year logic for the most part, but did like second year functional, and this has probably been my favourite module of the year - lots of practical stuff (weekly unassessed lab and homeworks, but you should still do them if you want to do well in the tests), the module team are all very keen on the topic and eager to help
- One of my favourite modules of my degree, Martín is the goat and the TAs are great too. The first half (at least) is much more akin to writing proofs than programming.
- If you liked Functional Programming and Logic and Computation, this will be the perfect module for you, this was one of my favourite modules of all time. Martin is simply amazing, and the TAs are very helpful and they will reply fast to your questions (on Teams). Despite some people saying this module is challenging, I did not find it so intellectually difficult. I believe anyone can do well in the tests as long as they complete all the homework and lab sheets (which is non-assessed, but essential for doing well in the class tests). Overall, I **strongly** recommend this module to anyone who enjoyed Haskell in Year 2
- Pretty difficult to start with but after getting the hang of it you can do well in the tests and it's incredibly satisfying when it all clicks.
- If you do take this module, don't use emacs but instead use VS Code, much better in my opinion
- If you felt like you understood agda or haskell this module honestly isn't so hard. Also, you know how well you do in any exercise sheet as for most questions "if it compiles, it's right".
- The lecturers are very good, and explain everything in a lot of detail and provide lots of resources every week for the content covered. They also hold weekly zoom/lab sessions where you can ask for help on anything
- This is a very intense and challenging module. I would only take this if you are very good at functional programming. Involves learning about Type Theory and representing proofs as programs. Requires a lot of time dedication.
- Similar to the other points here, this mod
- ule is quite difficult to get on with at points and takes a lot of time and effort to get all of the exercises done etc so would only recommend if you really loved the 2nd year module, but the whole module team are excellent and willing to put extra time in to help, and extremely fast feedback from the class tests

06-30209	**Advanced Networking**	20	-
06-30236	**Advanced Networking (Extended)**	20	-

- Was quite a fun & interesting module overall. The coursework consisted of evaluating how TCP works in various levels of packet loss, and creating a simple HTTP/S server to handle basic requests (he phoned this one in a bit)
- Really good module if you want to understand how networking works.
- Ian has a lot of interesting stories and examples of where things he is teaching about have happened in industry.
    - ^ Story time with Ian is a real thing
    - ^ and it's nice and refreshing to hear real industry stories
- I found the lectures quite draining to go through, and found myself very unsure what to be taking away from many of the lectures. The two 10% courseworks were very fun however. It's useful information in general to get, but I wish it was more engaging. I feel like 'advanced' is not true since it's very foundational.
- Not cutting edge, a lot of content about the history, why things are the way they are, and why ipv6 is never going to be a thing because ipv4 has so much going for it that would need translating into ipv6 (jk, it's having work put into it). A really worthwhile module to do as Networking is likely to be something that's worth knowing the basics of. Teaches you concepts which you can build upon yourself later.
- Was mentioned that the extended module would be no different from the non-extended version, not sure if this was in fact the case (edit by another student: yes, that was the case)
- An extremely good module
- Caveat this with Ian Batten seems to be notorious for not getting grades back in any reasonable amount of time
    - +1 to above
- Agree with all of these points, Ian clearly know his stuff and his stories are great but some of the content can be a bit dry at points, although I did find it a very interesting module, would also say that it seemed quite a content heavy module with lots of recorded lectures each week (which were also sometimes quite late)
- Agree content can be dry and there is A LOT of it. Lots of acronyms of obscure protocols etc.

06-35308	**Algorithms and Complexity**	-	20
06-35326	**Algorithms and Complexity (Extended)**	-	20

- Currently marked via (for non-extended at least):
    - Ten weekly 2% assignments, one question, usually pretty easy to get full marks
    - A midterm worth 30% (given whole week to do it with no other work to complete)
    - Final exam worth 50%
- This is a spicy one but a fun one
- If you like Big O notation and getting gritty into how optimisation works at a high level then you'll love this. If you dont you will hate it. Truly a marmite module.
- Challenging but the content is mostly quite clear and it's the type of thing that would probably be useful in a compsci career.
- Probably one of the best put together modules of them all. It's very clear what you're learning about and what you're taking away from the lectures. It's very engaging, Rajesh quite frequently gets student involvement in the lectures, asking us if we can see what the issue is, or how we'd attempt certain problems. It's massively useful if you

plan on going into a career such as software engineering, or anywhere where you'll want to develop efficient and effective algorithms.

06-30211	**Computer-Aided Verification**	20	-
06-30239	**Computer-Aided Verification (Extended)**	20	-

- This is a 'new' module for 2022, but is based on a 10 credit module that last ran in 2019-20, got absorbed into PLPDI for 2 years for covid reasons, and has now been expanded back out into its own module.
- Dave knows his shit, and is real good at explaining the content.
    - The content could possibly be dry if taught bad, but Dave keeps it fresh.
- Dave Parker is just a solid lecturer full stop
- Apparently the module lead is Mirco Giacobbe now and I dont see Dave's name anywhere on the canvas page so proceed with caution with this course.

06-30213	**Computer Vision and Imaging**	-	20
06-30241	**Computer Vision and Imaging (Extended)**	-	20

- Hamid is so passionate about this, and it really shows in the lectures. The lectures are well practised, and usually shorter than the full 50 minutes. Weekly formative Matlab labs with weekly personal feedback from the TAs if you remind them to release it. Haven't had any information about the assignment (50%) or what the exam will be like (50%)
- The lectures are really clear and engaging. While there is a bit of challenging maths it is explained really well.
- Having weekly feedback from TAs helps a lot with checking your understanding.
- You spend a lot of time looking at edge detection which is very interesting.
- Then the later half of the module is what Hamid finds interesting which is things like 3d imaging and medical imaging.

06-35310	**Evolutionary Computation**	-	20
06-35376	**Evolutionary Computation (Extended)**	-	20

- Add your opinion here…

06-30214	**Human-Computer Interaction**	20	-
06-30251	**Human-Computer Interaction (Extended)**	20	-

- The module is 100% coursework. 90% is the group coursework and 10% is a reflective essay.
    - I was lucky to have a good team so the whole group coursework went quite smoothly. Requires a fair amount of time-investment but wasn't too bad.
- First half is interesting, practical, and could be useful in a compsci career. Second half is based more on theory but the content is so incredibly niche that it's hard to imagine how most students would ever make use of It. The second half lecturer was also not very engaging or organised
- Russell Beale (first lecturer) is great. Puts a lot of effort into his pre-recorded videos
- While a lot of effort was put into the videos, they were mainly from the previous year I believe, and I never saw Russell in an in-person session (due to illness - his, not mine), so can't attest to his lecturing
- In-person sessions are not lectures, they are labs, so all content is delivered online
- Easy
- Content is not difficult
- A bit controversial but I didn't enjoy this module - Russell was great but much of the first half seemed to be mostly common sense or overlapped quite a bit with the 2nd year software engineering module, and Andrew's half seemed to go the other way and be extremely specific with a class test that was marked particularly harshly, with the mark scheme expecting things that hadn't even been asked about
    - No longer is a class test and there is no Andrew on the module anymore

06-99817	**Intelligent Interactive Systems**	-	20
06-93425	**Intelligent Interactive Systems (Extended)**	-	20

- This is a totally new module for 2022, not based on anything else that has come before
- Going to be taught by Andrew Howes, don't know what he's like?
    - From experience in HCI with Andrew this year I would be a little cautious, his lectures often seemed unorganised and his marking was quite harsh with minimal feedback
- Think it's quite fluffy and potentially not that much technical programming or complex theory?

06-30227	**Intelligent Robotics**	20	-
06-30244	**Intelligent Robotics (Extended)**	20	-

- Very time consuming, and we were not given much assistance on learning how to use ROS (the python framework for programming the robots). Expect to spend lots of hours for each assignment
- Do you like pain? (And not the good kind) Then this is the module for you!
- I spent more time on this module's assignments than all others combined. Do yourself a favour and pick a team if they give you a choice, it's already going to take you many long nights to get the assignments done, so make sure everybody is pulling their weight
- **MSci/MEng:** If you want to take this module do it in Y3 so you do the non-extended version. Extended has a 50% exam tied to it too and you don't need that - this is already a bloated module, do not give yourself the extra workload.

06-30229	**Machine Learning and Intelligent Data Analysis**	20	-
06-30255	**Machine Learning and Intelligent Data Analysis (Extended)**	20	-

- Pretty standard, not an exceptional module at the cutting edge of research but an excellent introduction to ML and Data Analysis. More on the Data analysis side, but I went to a Neural Networks and an Intelligent Robotics module in the beginning, and they do some of the same stuff but so much quicker and in less detail because they have other things to teach as well as ML. So the pace and the detail in this module is great because that's all it's there to teach.
- This module focuses quite a lot on the maths behind machine learning.
- If you like theory and maths then this is a good one to take. However it can take a lot of time to understand everything.
- Weekly quizzes do help with the module understanding.
- If you're doing any AI module, do this one too. It'll make the other modules easier.
- I think it's probably one of the harder modules you can pick. It's not a bad module to pick alongside Neural Computation however. The first few weeks of these modules share a lot in common.
- A bit like neural computation but harder and more maths.
- Module currently consists of an exam worth 80% and two pieces of coursework worth 10% each where you do some python code and then answer questions.

06-29289	**Mobile & Ubiquitous Computing**	-	20
06-25689	**Mobile & Ubiquitous Computing (Extended)**	-	20

- Note: This module has received a lot of negative feedback this year, mostly because it has previously been considered one of the best modules due to Sandy running the module. Sandy left suddenly over summer (as is his right and we all miss him), and so other lecturers had to step in.
    - It will most probably be led by different lecturers next year, and feedback from this year will reshape it into something different.
    - Therefore this is the most unknown module - **we do not know what it will look like next year.**

- I hate to say this one is relatively easy but….
    - The "exam" for us was 50 multiple choice questions online where you could just search the questions in the lecture slides. Worth 15% of the module
    - We haven't completed the main module coursework yet but the mark scheme is quite nice when it references how to get the marks
- Good if you want to know what "ubiquitous" means, not so great if you want to learn how to write mobile apps
- Personally I think the module is all over the place
- There is very little communication from the module leads when it comes to things like tests
- The content is very much an overview of everything to do with mobile and ubiquitous computing. Does not go into much detail of anything.
- Is interesting if you want to learn more about embedded devices.

- Don't expect to learn anything about mobile dev because the labs are just copying and pasting code. And none of it is assessed so it doesn't matter anyway.
- I think this module is really poor. The learning outcomes are so vague and the content is hand-wavy. It feels like the lecturers are just teaching us about papers they personally find interesting
- Few thousand pounds Youtube PREMIUM membership
- Agree with all of this, lectures consist of a series of YouTube videos and discussion about papers from the early 2000s, despite the progress in mobile computing since then, the class test was also an absolute waste of time, as are the lab "sessions"
- You will learn nothing about mobile development, the lab sheets really are just copy-paste and the attendance to the lab "sessions" is close to 0% (I "wonder" why). Lab sheets are optional, but even if you do them, they will not help you with the final project (which is 85% of the module) because you don't even need to do coding for the final assignment.
- It may be hard to believe but in a module called "Mobile and Ubiquitous computing", you do not need to do any coding whatsoever, instead, you will have to write a 5000 word report for 50% of the module and make a video for 35%.
- In the previous years, this module used to be taught by Sir Sandy, and the feedback was overwhelmingly positive. Now another lecturer took this module in a perfect state and he decided to rework it (God knows why) and turned it into an absolute disaster with mostly negative feedback. He replaced fun programming assignments with boring report writing and useless content during the lectures.
- The absence of a final exam may make it attractive, but this would be the only positive thing about the module so do not pick it.
- Lectures in the second half felt like Youtube with no ads. Youtube Premium is cheaper than this module. Too many people chose this module due to the positive feedback it had in the previous years, but now that the module leader has changed, do not make the same mistake.
- According to the logic of our module leader: it is more convenient for the students if the deadline for the final assignment is in week 11 instead of week 12
    - This has since been changed back to week 12
- A bit disappointed that this module is no longer run by Sandy, I was looking forward to that. It's been a ridiculous module so far - the easiest one I've ever done. There's no content and the class test was easy enough to get close to full marks even if you hadn't read the content in advance (not my situation, but it would've been super easy)
    - If it stays this way next year and you want a super easy (and non-inspirational) module, pick this one.
    - N.B. The reason why the module was no longer taught by Sandy is because he left the University, and moved to working at another institution
    - Also Sandy made a podcast, which some people found useful:
    - https://open.spotify.com/show/175XjNf2KkiEmNyakfmp62?si=JB4jz7peTnWIeawBg37edw&utm_source=copy-link
- Exam (15% of module) was akin to a primary school reading comprehension test
- Possibly controversial but I've really enjoyed this module and thought it was actually really well organised - the lecturers made it clear at the start what content would be covered each week and they have stuck to this, and the big coursework project was explained well with a fairly comprehensive mark scheme provided, and the lecturers

have been great at responding to emails with any questions about things ○ Admittedly the labs did seem a little pointless at times as they were mostly just copying and pasting code into Android Studio or Arduino

06-99999	**Natural Language Processing**	-	20
06-99998	**Natural Language Processing (Extended)**		

- This is a new module for 2022, probably based on a 10 credit module that last ran for second years in 2018-19
- A lot of students end up taking NLP projects. If you're thinking of doing that, take this module.
- In 2018, the assessment was just one assignment due at the end of the module, but the expectation was you started it in week 4 or something and chipped away at it. This won't necessarily be the case next year but if it is then get it out the way as soon as possible.
    - It's not too hard to do okay in the exam, but it's impossible to do great.

06-32167	**Neural Computation**	20	-
06-32212	**Neural Computation (Extended)**	20	-

- Challenging, but if you engage with it I think it's one of the most interesting modules. Not as hard as it's made out to be in my opinion (but not easy either)
- I agree with the above sentiments, that it's not as hard as it's made out to be. The group coursework was to develop a network to segment images for medical purposes. Was very interesting and I'm really happy we finally had a chance to make a neural network. It was only worth 20% sadly, but I think it's a nice balance. Exam wasn't too difficult given you can remember the equations.
- Gets into some relatively recent developments. Kostas who developed that part has left, but hopefully his content stays

06-30230	**Programming Language Principles, Design and Implementation**	20	-
06-30256	**Programming Language Principles, Design, and Implementation (Extended)**	20	-

- This is technically a new module for 2022, but is actually the same module that has been running for years.
    - In 2020-21 and 2021-22, it was combined with Computer Aided Verification for covid reasons. This module has now been split back off again and so it should probably go back to 'normal'
- **Computer Science Theory The Module**
- "We will now extend the lambda calculus -" x20
- Vincent is an absolute joy
    - He genuinely cares about tailoring the module and lectures to what people want

to get out of them
    - He also says 'rules' in an interesting way, and the word rules comes up a lot in this module
- I found this very challenging. Exam was very difficult (IMO not doable in 2h30 let alone 1h30...). Content is ok but will require more dedication compared to HCI or Mobile.

06-35307	**Quantum Computing**	-	20
06-35237	**Quantum Computing (Extended)**	-	20

- This is a totally new module for 2022, not based on anything that's come before.
- It will almost definitely be taught by Miriam who is an absolute delight and the only one in the department with the expertise to teach Quantum.
- heard good things about Miriam tho.
- This module will probably be oversubscribed :'(

06-34240	**Secure Software and Hardware Systems**	-	20

- This module is masters **ONLY**.
- Repeats quite a bit of content from 2nd Year C/C++ and 3rd/4th year Security of Real-World Systems. (David Oswald uses the same slides for a few lectures from SoRWS with slight modification to module-name references).
- Get to program on a raspberry pi pico.
- More of Ian Batten (Yay!)

06-30231	**Security of Real-World Systems**	20	-
06-30257	**Security of Real-World Systems (Extended)**	20	-

- Security lecturers best lecturers
- If you didn't enjoy your Introduction to Security module, this probably is not the choice for you. The first lecture is basically a direct continuation of the last thing you learnt about in that module
    - This is true, although I feel like I struggled with this module less than with second year security, excluding the january exam, which was brutal compared to the past papers
- Tom Chothia teaches the first half, David Oswald teaches the second half. Both are excellent, accomplished lecturers who are both knowledgeable and passionate about their subjects
- A great example of what a proper module is. The two lecturers explain the contents in a very clear way and it is obvious that they are both passionate about what they are teaching. If you liked the second year security module, I would strongly recommend choosing this one. The exam for 2021/2022 was indeed harder than the past papers, but it wasn't unfair, it was definitely possible to get an honourable grade.
- They also talk about more recent research in this module, including some of the stuff they have done themselves. There's a lot of case studies which are interesting to find out about.
    - The last few lectures go into real state-of-the-art stuff
- The assessment consists mostly of applying what theory you've learnt *very* practically,

similar to the Intro to Security module but without a VM/tokens. There is one (randomly allocated) group assignment where the task requires you to hack a given game client to get flags and then program/design cheats for the game.
- This is a great module which is extremely well organised and goes into depth about several different aspects of security and the practical implementations of various attacks, and follows on very nicely from the 2nd year security module

06-30208	**Teaching Computer Science in Schools**	-	20
06-30235	**Teaching Computer Science in Schools (Extended)**	-	20

- It's a really fun and rewarding module, as you get to do placements in a local school. It's also quite rewarding to be able to make an impact on the children in the schools. It is also a very different style of module than all of the others.
- It's a 2nd Semester module, but there are COMPULSORY lectures you must attend in the 1st Semester (attendance will be taken).
- During these lectures, you will learn the basics of teaching, and you will also prepare a short presentation with your partner. The topic will be on something like the tools you could use in a classroom. This is a chance to do some presenting before placements, and also share ideas with the rest of the class. The presentation isn't really graded but it is important to do it well.
- In 2022, we went back to doing in person placements, where in 2021 it was still Covid.
- There are a limited number of spaces, so only about half of the people who originally joined the module were able to stay on it. This year there were only ~26 places. You had to write a personal statement in the first few weeks of Sem1, which was used to work out who would stay on the module. If choosing this module, be prepared with another module option, in case you have to switch.
- Placements are full school days (~8:30am-3pm, etc (obviously, depends on the school)). Be prepared to have to travel to a school which may be local, or outside of Birmingham. You will have to get up early.
- You will likely be in pairs to go to a school together.
- Module grades are based on weekly reports, final report, placement teacher feedback, and a poster presentation.
- Extended module assessment includes a little extra work in the final report.
- Do not do this module if you think you won't enjoy doing the placements.
- You will do 8 days of placements in total in the 2nd Semester, with an extra initial visit before Christmas holiday. You will usually go 1 day per week.
- In your placement, you are expected to eventually plan and deliver whole lessons. You will go to a secondary school, where you will most likely be in Year 7-9 lessons. Sometimes you might also be in GCSE classes, but this is negotiable with your teacher. This year there were also some primary schools available.
- You will also need to deliver an extracurricular club during your placements. The content of this is up to you and your partner. You will create a poster based on what you deliver, and there will be a poster presentation session (attendance compulsory) before Summer exams.
- Your engagement and professionalism is a key theme throughout this module, so it is important to not slack off and be lazy.
- Trivial things on this module include getting a DBS Check (will be expensed), good time

management, and confidence in public speaking
- Since few people will go through on the module, I'm happy to answer more Qs - Likkan
    - Q: Can you choose which school you attend? For example if you would like to try and teach at your old secondary school.
    - A: if your school would be willing to have you there to do the placements then most likely yes but this would have to be agreed by the module team, otherwise allocations are essentially random (you get to choose your partner and put a preference of primary or secondary)
- This was a very good module especially for anyone who might be considering a career in teaching as it gives you some great experience, from my experience the workload increases as you get further through the placements (as you have more preparation to do for the lessons, however this could be different if some schools might expect you just to teach their pre-prepared lessons) but it's very rewarding

Further Advice

For everyone

- Module credit balance can really fuck things up/make things better. If you choose an unbalanced load of modules for the two semesters (for example, 80:40 split), know what you are signing up for is a lot less free time in that first term.
  If planning to take 3 modules in a term, it may be worth having at least 1 be 100% coursework so your exam time is less chaotic.
    - **For MSci/MEng**:
    - The M60 module is 20/40 split, leaving you with only 3 modules, leading to the 2nd semester only having 1 module to take. Consider this carefully.
    - Q: would it be possible to do 2 modules in the second semester and 1 in the first or is this a bad idea?
        - Was asked in a Q&A session at the start of year - it's allowed, but remember time management is your responsibility - if project tasks overrun it may be harder to find the time in a busier second semester. (On the plus side, you get more time to work on the project as submission is in the easter holidays rather than at the end of the semester)
- Final year will be hard, let's be honest, it should challenge you. But it shouldn't break you. Welfare is your friend.
- Pick modules that you're interested in, not what is perceived to be easy. The module leads can change between years so the module may look different to other years.
- The University is thinking of going back to in-person exams next year. That means exams will not be open book, and you will need to learn everything you need in advance before you enter the exam hall. Take this into account
    - If you aren't good at remembering equations, don't take a module with a maths-heavy exam. Also consider that many exams are also non-calculator.
    - If you are a slow writer, maybe try to pick more 100% continuous assessment, or 50%:50% modules.

    - If this is going to be your 3rd year, some of you may not have taken an in person exam since GCSE (was that in like 2018?). Remember that your uni exams are much the same style as GCSE/ALevel exams, just harder and usually in a much bigger exam hall. You'll get question papers like the online exams, but you won't be typing it. So make sure to have reasonable legible handwriting.
- The NSS (National Student Survey) happens in March of the final year. Complete it early if you want the School to stop pestering you to do it (although this probably won't happen). Alternatively, you can use it as a tool if Mark/HoS/whoever try to tempt you to do it by putting on pizza/drinks
- Although final year is big and important (especially FYP). Do still make sure to balance your time, and not spend all of it doing your project. Although this sounds trivial, don't forget to take part in whatever societies/sports/hobbies/etc you enjoy. Take reasonable breaks often so you don't burn out. Equally, don't spend too much time relaxing or you won't do enough work.
- **MSci/MEng doing a Year in Industry:**
    - If you are reading this and are doing a placement year instead, the University puts your placement in Year 3, but you actually will be doing it in Year 4. This creates the confusing situation where you do the Year 4 modules (1st half of your stage-3 (i.e. 'final year')) in your third year at Uni, and your Year 3 placement in your fourth year of study. Your 5th year (final (12 months) year) will be as normal.
    - If you are not doing your placement this year, and choosing modules, then you need to change the 'year' of modules to select from on the website. Instead of the default option of MSci/MEng Year 3, you need to change it to Year 4, to choose those modules instead (which you will complete in your third year of study)
    - Relatively few people do the MSci/MEng with Ind. Ask Likkan (author of this point) if you want to know more.
- **More for MSci/MEng generally:**
    - For the purposes of this paragraph, your final year (officially, 'stage 3') is over 2 years. I will write them here as Y3 and Y4/5 (5 is for those doing YrInInd). You will have the same (or similar (depending on how module changes over the year)) options available in both. In your Y3 year you do the normal module, but will do the **Extended** version in Y4/5. General suggestion is to choose the ones you want to do now for this year. They may not be the same / existing next year or in 2 years after a placement. E.g. module leads may change and the module content may change a bit.
    - The Extended module is usually the same as the non-extended version. You have the same lectures, but it usually includes some extra learning outcomes, which will be assessed by an extra assignment.
    - If you do the non-extended version of a module in Y3, **you cannot take the extended version of the same module in Y4/5.** That means over your third and final year, you will take 5x semester 1 modules, and 4x semester 2 modules. Modules do not generally move from one semester to another, so it's a good plan to think about what you would pick for both years

For Maths and Computer Science students

- IMO Research Skills in Mathematics is an easier module to be taken in your third year, compared to the computer science project. It does not expect you to create something novel, but to be able to understand scientific content.
- Also, the MSci project in mathematics is again better in terms of organisation compared to the MSci computer science project. Most of the time, in the school of mathematics you pick a project from a list of around 200 different suggestions. The project is in the area of expertise of the supervisor, so they can guide you along the way. That does not mean that they will do the work for you, but will be helpful in feedback. In computer science, you have to choose a topic, and your supervisor could be unfamiliar with it. In these circumstances, you should be careful when picking a supervisor, as someone with little experience in project supervision might not be very helpful. Also, the masters project in mathematics seems to be structured better, compared to the computer science one. Additionally, the deadlines in the mathematics project seem more like checkpoints to hit which should help you navigate through the report, while some deadlines in the computer science project seem like additional work, which is not related to the project. An example of that is creating a video presentation, which contributed 10% of the final grade in our year, which is never used afterwards. While in mathematics parts of the report are being graded along the way of you writing it. Overall, my advice would be to pick the MSci project in mathematics, as you will get better guidance, unless you really know what you want to do with your computer science project and you believe that your supervisor will motivate you.

For Degree Apprentice students

For PwC

- Forget about PwC they can piss off when we're at uni (except FYP) (to be fair they hardly care about how relevant your FYP is to PwC, they have to care cos the govt says so, but they don't really)
- Worth keeping an eye on emails though as I have been invited to some socials and such closer to the end to meet w/ the team I will be placed into
- PwC students absolutely can consider leaving - particularly if you're disappointed with placements as you'll likely be given an offer to return to the team you've been with for the year
    - A fair amount of people in current final year have got offers for good companies elsewhere with more money and the promise of actually getting to write code

Final Year Project

- You have to meet the Institute of Apprenticeships' requirements?
    - I've not bothered with this… what's the worst they can do?
- We have to do another presentation to PwC at the end of the project. It seems to be quite similar to the normal one but you just need to "PwC-ify" it. Talking about the requirements mentioned above

For Vodafone

- Lack of communication from Vodafone in Final Year
- You are stuck with them unless you choose to fail your apprenticeship, which you can

do, but would need to pay the clawback fees, plus any remaining university fees that the uni chooses to make you pay in order for you to get a standard BSc with year in industry

- This year, final job allocations are done based on your placement review thing you do at the end of the placement. Be clear about what you want, if you didn't like your placement, say that or you risk going back there.
- Allocations are done later than you may see your friends getting job offers, but don't worry, as much as you are stuck with Vodafone for the next two years, Vodafone is also obligated to look after you, so they have to take care of you and will eventually sort everything out.
- As with PwC, Vodafone don't really care what your final year project is
- The Institute for Apprenticeships cares what your final year project is, in that it allows you to meet certain criteria (Read all about it here). It's clear how you get all of them if you do something related to your placement, or business in general, but you can also do whatever you want and blag it. I think the uni isn't going to make it hard for you, any small connection you come up with will be good enough.
- As with PwC, two additional meetings after Easter to make sure you've done everything you need to do in order to pass the apprenticeship, will be blag-able.